Which cabbage?

☞ **1** Use the word bank to fill in the passage below.

Word bank

same
Australia
plant
scientific
cabbage
different
Animals

In the Pacific people eat leafy greens called c_____. In Tonga they call their cabbage *pele*. In Papua New Guinea it's called *aibika*, and in the Solomon Islands it's *slippery cabbage*. It's all exactly the same p_____ – but is it the s_____ as *Chinese cabbage*? How are these plants d_____ to the round type we eat in A_____? Farmers and scientists need to be sure which plant is which. That's why scientists give plants s_____ names – so there is no confusion. A_____ have **scientific names** too.

Hibiscus cabbage	**European cabbage**	**Chinese cabbage**
Grows to approx. 1 m	Grows to approx. 50 cm	Grows to approx. 50 cm
Thin, round stems	Short, curved stems	Long, flattened stems
Pointy leaves with slimy sap	Big round curved leaves	Long broad wrinkly leaves
Bushy shrub	Ball-shaped growth	Upright growth



Brassica oleracea



Abelmoschus manihot



Brassica rapa

2 Look at the pictures and table above. Tick the characteristics that you can see in the pictures, then match each of the pictures to one of the types of cabbage listed in the table.

3 Draw lines joining each common name to its scientific name.

Hibiscus cabbage	*Brassica rapa*
European cabbage	*Abelmoschus manihot*
Chinese cabbage	*Brassica oleracea*

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